

PREEMPTIVE MAJOR RAISE

Partner opens 1♥ or 1♠. With about 3-6 HCP, five-plus trumps, and a shapely hand, jump straight to game. The raise is weak and distributional, not an invitation: it shows the fifth (often sixth) trump and shortness, bids to the level of the fit, and takes the opponents' room away. Opener trusts the picture and passes a normal opening, since the raise has already placed the contract. When the opponents intervene, an invitational raise is often more effective.